

Obvious answer: the situation in which the child lives and you have wet clothes is better than the one in which the child dies and you stay dry. But that assumes that consequentialism is true.

We can present this line of thought as an argument:

1. In the example of the drowning child, you should save the child.
2. The explanation of (1) is that you should always act so as to bring about the best consequences.

C. Consequentialism is true. (2)

The best explanation argument for consequentialism

Consequentialism

An action is right if, of all available options, it would lead to the best outcome, and wrong otherwise.

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